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## Position Paper Islamic Republic of Iran

**Committee:** United Nations General Assembly

**Agenda:** The Militarization of Artificial Intelligence

**Opening Remarks:** The Islamic Republic of Iran offers its greetings to the esteemed Chair and fellow delegates. We are gathered here to address an issue with profound consequences for international peace, security, and the future of human dignity itself: **the steady militarisation of Artificial Intelligence (AI)**. This is not some far-off threat we can afford to debate endlessly; it is a clear and present danger. The development of AI-powered weaponry, especially Lethal Autonomous Weapons Systems (LAWS), risks automating the act of bloodshed, lowering the barriers to conflict, and igniting a terrifying new arms race that could destabilise the entire global order. We in the Islamic Republic of Iran believe this agenda cannot be discussed in a vacuum. It must be viewed within the context of the current geopolitical landscape: a landscape marred by **unilateralism, illegal sanctions**, and the **hegemonic ambitions** of a few powerful states. It is these same states, with a documented history of using devastating force to achieve their political aims, that are now leading the charge in the AI arms race. They present this technology as a way to enhance security, but their actions point to a desire for unchallenged military dominance. This creates a security dilemma that naturally compels other nations, including our own, to find credible means of self-defence.

**The Problem:** The core problem is that AI development is rapidly outpacing the creation of corresponding international law. From Iran's perspective, this creates three primary dangers that threaten our national sovereignty and regional stability:

**Danger A: Destabilising Asymmetry and Coercion:** The monopolisation of offensive AI by a few technologically advanced states, the very states that have historically pursued policies of pressure against Iran, creates an unacceptable power imbalance. It provides our adversaries with new tools for sabotage against our critical infrastructure and for conducting military strikes with perceived impunity, compelling nations like Iran to develop costly deterrent capabilities to ensure our national security.

**Danger B: The Accountability Vacuum as a Political Tool:** We are concerned that autonomous systems will be used by powerful states to conduct unattributable attacks and targeted assassinations, circumventing international law and norms of sovereignty. This creates a dangerous legal void where aggressor states can deny culpability for actions that would otherwise constitute clear acts of war, undermining the foundational principles of International Humanitarian Law (IHL).

**Danger C: Risk of Regional Escalation:** In the tense security environment of the Middle East, the deployment of AI-driven systems operating at machine speed drastically increases the risk of miscalculation. A technical error or a misinterpretation of defensive posturing could trigger a catastrophic conflict that spirals out of control before human-led diplomacy can intervene.

## **Our Proposals:**

### **1. CCW Protocol VII on AI-Enabled Weapons and Meaningful Human Control**

Iran will sponsor negotiations for a new, opt-in Protocol VII under the Convention on Certain Conventional Weapons that codifies “meaningful human control” as a universal legal requirement for any use of lethal force, prohibits fully autonomous offensive weapons, and includes a *South–South Technology Assistance Annex* ensuring that defensive AI research, verification tooling and algorithmic audits remain accessible to developing states.

## 2. UN “Defensive-by-Design” Transparency Registry

Pursuant to UNGA resolution 79/239, Iran will champion the creation of a registry within UNODA where States annually list AI systems whose *sole* function is point-defence, early warning or kinetic interception. Entries are peer-reviewed through red-team audits at national AI Testing Centres, beginning with a pilot exercise hosted in Tehran. States submitting to the registry also endorse a voluntary moratorium on autonomous first-strike operations.

## 3. Responsible AI Stewardship & End-Use Screening Framework (“Wassenaar-Plus”)

Rather than replicating traditional export-control clubs, Iran proposes a UN *Programme of Action on Military AI Stewardship* that aligns with UNSCR 1540 obligations. It adds an “AI-enabled systems” column to the UN Register of Conventional Arms, obliges major exporters to certify end-users, and establishes a Capacity-Building Fund, financed by voluntary contributions from emerging AI powers, to help developing states license, trace and audit sensitive algorithms.

## 4. Middle-East AI Security & De-Escalation Dialogue

Building on the Tehran Dialogue Forum, Iran will convene a *Gulf–Caspian AI Stewardship Compact* open to regional states only. Core deliverables include:

- A hotline for AI-related incidents,
- A mutual pledge not to target medical or energy infrastructure with autonomous or AI-directed cyber tools, and
- A region-specific Code of Conduct drafted with technical support from UNIDIR and filed with the UN Secretariat under Chapter VIII of the Charter.

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